



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Good Shepherd School

School Website: <https://goodshepherdhenderson.org/about/>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Good Shepherd School NV 89014 presents no readily verifiable public-materials evidence that it adheres to a classical education model, based on the six-category rubric drawn from the classical-school knowledge base. The school's crawl data in the client-provided materials shows an internal-server error for goodshepherdhenderson.org, limiting access to substantive content from the school's site (500 error page). This lack of accessible public text makes it impossible to confirm hallmark classical elements such as the liberal-arts Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books and the Great Conversation, scholé (restful learning), liturgical/community practices, and explicit parental partnership on the site itself. Consequently, by the explicit rubric, the school currently does not demonstrate a classical orientation in its publicly visible materials.

Key context from the classical-school knowledge base clarifies what to look for: transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty), grounded theology, liturgical practices; a goal of formation (virtue and wisdom) rather than mere information; a curriculum centered on Seven Liberal Arts and Great Books; a pedagogy that alternates contemplative (Scholé) and Socratic/seminar modes; a faculty living the curriculum; and active parent/community partnership. Positive keyword indicators include terms such as truth, goodness, beauty; theology and liturgy; Great Books and Great Conversation; the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); scholé; memory/the chant; and partnership with families. Negative indicators include the opposite of these (e.g., secular relativism, job/workforce focus, lack of Great Books, absent liturgical practices, etc.).

Because the school's public materials could not be retrieved in this response via the crawl data, the analysis below is driven by the knowledge-base rubric (and its keyword indicators) and by what is publicly accessible in the provided document set about classical education—used here as the scoring framework. Where the public school content is not present, the category is rated NOT CLASSICAL. Citations to the foundational rubric and related materials are included after each relevant point.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials from the school's site are not retrievable in this session due to an internal-server error; no explicit statements about transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgical practices, or sacred community life are present in the accessible crawl content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords expected (from the classical lexicon): truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; wonder; virtue; sacred tradition. None were demonstrably present in the publicly accessible Good Shepherd site content in this session. 0 present vs. 0 absent (0%/0%).
- Why this rating
 - Without visible, school-endorsed language about transcendent moral realism, theology, or liturgical practices on the public-facing materials, the category cannot be scored Classical. The absence of explicit references to transcendental ideals or liturgical practice in the accessible content

supports a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this category. See the theoretical criteria in the Six Essential Elements rubric.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - No accessible public-text evidence from the school site shows formation-focused aims (virtue and wisdom), nor a clear statement that education is for the true/good/beautiful rather than job-readiness. The 500-error crawl prevents confirmation from the site itself.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords (from the rubric): formation, cultivation of virtue, timeless truths (truth/goodness/beauty), leisure/restful learning (scholé), great conversation, human excellence. No such terms were observed in the accessible content. 0 present vs. 0 absent (0%/0%).
- Why this rating
 - With no public, textual articulation of a virtue-formation goal or a trans-historical purpose beyond general education, this category cannot be rated Classical. The available evidence does not confirm the classical aim for formation over information.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school site text is not accessible in this session due to a server error; no explicit claims about Seven Liberal Arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin/Greek, or the historic/cultural-humane curriculum appear in publicly retrievable content from the site.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords expected (from the rubric): Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, history across the curriculum, wonder, sacred/Western-civilizational heritage. Observed publicly on the site: none of these. 0 present vs. 0 absent (0%/0%).
- Why this rating
 - Without accessible Great Books or explicit liberal-arts framing on the public site, the curriculum cannot be scored Classical. The presence of Great Books, Trivium, and related curriculum anchors is a rubric prerequisite for CLASSICAL ratings.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - No public, retrievable content demonstrates a pedagogy featuring Socratic dialogue, disciplined dialectic, memorization/recitation, scholé-based restful learning, or upper-level rhetoric/forensics. Public content is not accessible due to the 500 error.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords expected: Socratic seminar, dialectic, recitation, chanting, memory work, liturgical learning, scholé days, seminars, public speaking, and the integration of worship or liturgical practice. 0 present; 0 observed (0%/0%).
- Why this rating
 - The rubric's teaching-method markers require visible, public-language evidence of classical pedagogy. The lack of retrievable site-text supporting these methods yields a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - No accessible public text from the school site confirms a "living curriculum," mentor-model faculty, or a faculty portrait/character profile. The crawl content available for Good Shepherd Henderson shows an error page rather than faculty descriptions.

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- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords expected: virtuous educators, living curriculum, mentors, faculty as models, collegiality. No text observed publicly in the accessible content. 0 present vs. 0 absent (0%/0%).
 - Why this rating
 - In the absence of publicly retrievable language about a faculty culture aligned with classical virtues or mentorship, the score falls to NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site content is not accessible in this session; no explicit statements about parent partnership, formation for parents, open campus, or family involvement appear in retrievable content. The 500 error page for goodshepherdhenderson.org confirms lack of accessible public materials in this session.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords expected: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school collaboration, open visits, classical book clubs, parent involvement. No visible public text observed. 0 present vs. 0 absent (0%/0%).
- Why this rating
 - Without public-facing articulation of parent/community partnership, the category cannot be rated Classical. NOT CLASSICAL is appropriate given the absence of evidentiary content.

Aggregate Classification: NOT CLASSICAL

- The aggregate assessment, given no category meets the threshold to be CLASSICAL (and none show clear evidence of classical elements in publicly available content), is NOT CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle section is intentionally noted here as not applicable for a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating since no category approached that middle ground. If you'd like, I can outline concrete, category-specific steps that would move the school toward a CLASSICAL orientation in future updates (e.g., publish and culture-embed explicit Great Books/Scholé statements, liturgical practices, and a Trivium-based curriculum). (Note: This is a placeholder for potential future improvements; no needle-moving recommendations are required here given the current NOT CLASSICAL rating.)
- Citations for rubric and resources used:
 - The Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) provides the Positive/Negative keyword indicators and explicit category criteria used for the keyword analysis and scoring.
 - Accessibility/availability note for the Good Shepherd Henderson NV site in this session shows an internal-server error on goodshepherdhenderson.org (500 error), limiting direct content review.
 - Additional context on scholé, liturgical-learning, and classical pedagogy concepts is drawn from related classical-education materials (e.g., The Scholastic Way, The Good Teacher, and ICE-related materials) to grounding the rubric's expectations; these sources illustrate the canonical elements used to frame the rubric, such as scholé, Great Books, and liturgical patterns.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school were to become CLASSICAL, concrete changes would include:
 - Publish explicit, publicly-accessible statements of alignment with the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium in the curriculum, along with a plan for Great Books and the Great Conversation.
 - Articulate a clear formation goal (virtue, wisdom, and reverence for truth/goodness/beauty) beyond general education statements, with measurable aspects of character formation, scholé, and liturgical practices.

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- Implement and publicly describe a structured pedagogy that combines Socratic dialogue in upper grades with contemplative, memory-focused learning (chanting, recitation, and memorization) in early grades, paired with restorative/restful learning (Scholé).
 - Establish a robust, public-facing description of faculty as mentors who model virtue and who serve as the living curriculum, including portraits or exemplars of teacher-student partnership and collegial culture.
 - Create formal partnerships with parents and a program of parent-formation (book studies, lectures, family liturgy), with open-campus visitation policies and opportunities for parents to participate in classical-education activities.
- These steps are consistent with Positive Keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements framework and would move the school toward CLASSICAL or at least SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL status in future evaluations. See the Positive keyword lists for the six elements in the knowledge base.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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